

by Acorn. First released in 1987, its origins can be traced back to the original team that developed the ARM microprocessor. RISC OS is owned by Castle Technology Limited. "I have spent a lot of time while I was young with Acorn Archimedes and RiscPC products. This is a great moment for me personally to see an evolved version of the original ARM operating system to be featured in the Raspberry Pi. From the Foundation's point of view, we welcome the arrival of an alternative desktop environment, offering a rich suite of applications, and with BBC BASIC only a few keystrokes away," said Eben Upton, founder, Raspberry Pi Foundation.

Windows 8 may fail to woo consumers: Linux Foundation

Microsoft may be going gaga over its latest Windows 8 operating system, especially designed to function on traditional desktops as well as on touch devices. But the Linux Foundation feels that this strategy of Microsoft may not work as the consumers are used to Linux-based software. Jim Zemlin, executive director of the Linux Foundation, feels that consumers use Windows 8 with a keyboard and mouse instead of a touch screen. "Microsoft is stuck in the space between the desktop-driven, cost per software licence world they dominated and the era we are just now entering: a world driven by open source software and services," said Zemlin, in his official blog posting. Zemlin further explained that the computers are slowly becoming synchronous with portability and Microsoft's hybrid operating system approach for Windows 8 is a good move but "...perhaps bad to apply a 'Jack of all trades' approach that may not work so well for their existing bread and butter desktop users."

In another instance, Microsoft said that it has disabled USB charging in its recently launched Surface tablets as it wants people to carry either a laptop or a Surface, or even better, only a Surface to meet all their computing requirements. But a Gartner analyst has something different to say. "I like Windows 8 on a Tablet, but not on a desktop, which is unfortunately where I will use it."

New to Linux? Try Linux Lite 1.0.0

If you are a newbie in the world of Linux, the newly launched open source distro Linux Lite 1.0.0 is just for you. The official announcement about the availability of the distro was made by Jerry Bezencon. According to a post, Linux Lite is free for everyone to use and share, and suitable for people who are new to Linux or for people who want a lightweight environment that is also fully functional.

The makers of the distro claim that it was created for three reasons. They explain, "One, to show people just how easy it can be to use a Linux-based operating system—to dispel myths about how scary Linux operating systems are; two, to help create awareness about Linux-based operating systems; and three, to help promote this community."



LibreOffice 3.6.3 released

This piece of news is sure to bring a smile to the faces of open source fans. The version 3.6.3 of LibreOffice open source word productivity suite has been released by The Document Foundation. The new release comes with more than 90 bug fixes including solutions to layout problems, overflowing margins, as well as issues that arise while importing and exporting ODF documents.

The LibreOffice 3.6.3 is available for Linux, Windows and MacOS platforms and according to official sources, "This new release is another step forward in the process of improving the overall quality and stability for any kind of deployment, on personal desktops or inside organisations and across companies of any size."



Florian Effenberger, chairman of the board, The Document Foundation, has requested LibreOffice users to support the foundation financially by generous donations: "If you enjoy LibreOffice, please donate and help us with our budget for 2013," said Effenberger in his Google+ page.

After the Foundation's Hard Hacks initiative, several fixes in the third maintenance update to the 3.6.x group were introduced. The Hard Hacks programme was initiated to tackle complicated bugs in the software's code.